

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
♥ 10 8 5 3
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ K 6 4 2

♠ A Q 9 6 5 3

♥ K 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ A 8



♠ K 8 4

♥ 9 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q J 10 5 3

♠ J 10 7

♥ A Q J 4

♦ 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

You know you are going to get to dummy with a ♥ and then try the ♠ finesse. Your big worry should be that if the ♠ finesse loses West will be able to get the lead and play a ♦ through your ♦ K 8.

So ask yourself: "How is West going to get the lead?" The only trick he could win would be the ♣K which he almost surely has. But you can keep this from happening by simply holding up on the first ♣ trick. Win the next one with your ♣A, enter dummy with a ♥ and take the ♠ finesse. It loses, but to East who can't hurt you with a ♦ play.

Recognize that West is the Danger Hand because he can lead a ♦.

Then think about how to keep West from getting the lead - in this case holding up on the first trick.

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♠.

With 18 points you want to invite partner to bid game if he has 9 or 10 points. While you could do this with a 3♠ bid it is more informative to use a Help Suit Game try - bidding 3 of the suit you'd most like help in. You bid 3♥.

Partner has magnificent help in the ♥ suit so he bids 4♠.

North to play 4♠. East leads the ♣Q.

North to play 4♠. East leads the ♣Q. West plays ♣6.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
♥ Q J 10 4
♦ A 9 5 3
♣ Q J 9 5

♠ K J 6 2

♥ K 7 3

♦ J 4

♣ K 7 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 5

♥ 9 6 5

♦ 10 7 6 2

♣ A 10 8 4

♠ Q 10 9 7 4 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q 8

♣ 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
your "slow" ♥ loser. There are two possibilities, but each must be tried immediately because once you lose the lead the defenders will set up their ♥.

You could win the ♥ in your hand and lead toward the ♣K. If West holds ♣A you can establish the ♣K for a ♥ discard.

You could win in dummy and set up a ♦ no matter which defender holds ♦A. You could then discard a ♥ from dummy on your good ♦. This is obviously the better choice since it works with any distribution.

Win the first trick with dummy's ♥K and play ♦J. Continue ♦s until they take the ♦A. Win their return with your ♥A and discard dummy's ♥7 on your good ♦. Only then do you start on trumps.

It was wise to choose to set up your ♦ rather than dummy's ♣K because the ♦ play did not depend on a fortunate placement of the cards.

A very important part of this Plan was where you chose to win the first trick. Since entries are a problem with either hand you had to save the high ♥ as entry to the hand that would have the eventual winner.

With four trumps and 11-12 points you have a pretty standard limit raise.

So you bid 3 ♠ and partner raises to game.

North would play 4 ♠.

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South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥Q.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have a loser in each suit and must eliminate one of them. Since the defense can take their Aces whenever they want to you need to find a place to put